

If electronics are exposed to dust for a long period without any cleaning, their performance will be hampered. However, it's not as simple as dropping them in soap water. Proper care and cleaning material must be used to clean them. In this chapter, we will be discussing effective ways to clean your gadgets.

Gadget cleaning tips & tricks

Apple advises its iPhone users to use a wipe that has 70 percent isopropyl alcohol or Clorox Disinfecting Wipes to gently wipe the exterior surface of their iPhones. Apple experts strongly discourage the use of bleach and/or submerging of iPhones in any cleaning agents and also suggest avoiding moisture in any openings of the smartphone. This advice is sound for pretty much any phone, not just iPhones.

Age-old techniques such as damp cloths, elbow grease, and soap are still popular and readily available to remove hard dirt or grime. If you want to kill the tiny microbes that have made a house on your gadgets, products like sanitizers or cleaning sprays with at least 60 percent of rubbing alcohol will be more than sufficient to disinfect your electronics.

The use of “electronic cleaning cloths” and “electronic cleaner” items to clean your gadgets can be costly as they are rebranded, less effective, and expensive compared to conventional household cleaning products. To clean your gadgets at home on your own, you just need to grab some pure cotton cloths or microfiber chamois, isopropyl alcohol, distilled water, Q-tips, dish soap and our effective guidelines to make your gadgets sparkle and shine.

NOTE: When cleaning your gadgets at home, do not forget to unplug and switch off your gadgets. Also, carefully read your gadget manufacturer's instructions because some gadgets have particular and very specific cleansing instructions, which if not followed, can damage the gadget that might not be covered under warranties of the gadget.

Laptops and Hybrids

If you have the right tools and skills, cleaning laptops inside out is possible at home. First, unplug and shut down your laptop, and remove the batteries, if that brand/model permits it. Don't worry if you can't remove the batteries.

- I. Now, with the help of compressed air or microfiber cloth you can blow out the dust first, and then using Isopropyl alcohol or ethanol or a solution of diluted dish soap, you can gently wipe the screen and other high touch surfaces to disinfect it.
- II. To prepare the dish soap solution, you have to mix a single drop of the